

Both a CV and resume represent your experiences and skills and are used in an application process to get you an interview. A CV presents a full history of your academic accomplishments, while a resume presents a concise summary of your qualifications. While both are tailored for the specific position you are applying to, they are used for different purposes with CVs being required for academic positions and resumes being needed otherwise. Graduate school applications typically request a CV but in general are looking for an expanded resume that includes any publications and descriptions of research projects. If you are applying for both academic as well as industry (private or public sector) positions, you will need to prepare both a resume and a CV.

CV vs. Resume

CV	Resume
Emphasizes involvement and academic accomplishments	Emphasizes skills and experiences
Used for applying to academic positions, such as graduate school and faculty	Used for applying to most positions
Lengths varies but typically does not have a limit	Typically 1 page (2 pages may be applicable for advanced applicants)
Sections and experiences may move or be taken off as you advance in your career	Sections and experiences may move or be taken off as you advance in your career

The Key Components of a Great Resume

Although resumes vary with industry and experience, there are certain components that hiring managers expect all resumes to include. These elements help provide insights on your qualifications as a candidate and prove that you are an ideal match for the job.

A well-written resume should include the following elements:

1. Contact information

Your resume should always include your name and contact information at the top of the document. This information should stand out from the rest of your resume, making it easier for the reader to know how to reach you. Provide the following details:

- Your telephone number
- Your email address
- The city and state where you currently reside

Depending on the type of job you are applying for, you may want to include a link to your professional social media profile or website. These can serve as a resource to provide additional information about your career and examples of your work.

2. Professional objective or summary

Pick the option that best matches your experience level or career situation. Whichever you choose, you will place this section at the top of your resume, below your contact information but above your professional experience section. Always include information that aligns with the job to which you are applying, as this will prove you are qualified to take on the responsibilities of the role.

- A resume objective: One to two sentences that introduce your qualifications and highlights your career goals. It is best suited for entry-level candidates or individuals making a career change.
- A professional summary: A short description, about three to five sentences, of your most significant and relevant attributes and achievements. Choose a summary if you have at least three years of professional experience.

3. Professional experience

Your professional experience will take up the most significant space on your resume, so ensure it creates a clear picture of your qualifications. Avoid focusing on the tasks or responsibilities you held during your previous jobs, and instead offer examples of your accomplishments to prove your value as an employee. Try to include as many measurable details as possible, whether they are percentages related to results you created or quantify the amount of work you accomplished in a particular amount of time. This section should include the following information:

- Your position titles
- Name of employers
- Location of employers
- Dates of employment
- Brief bullet points about your significant responsibilities and accomplishments in the role

As a general rule, only include your last 10 to 15 years of professional experience. Limiting the number of jobs you list can help keep your resume concise and allow you to focus on your most relevant experience. Also list other experiences, such as internships, part-time jobs, freelance work or volunteer work, as long as they relate to the skills or requirements of the position to which you are applying.

4. Skills

Your resume should include a section that details the specific skills you have that are relevant to the position. Put this bulleted list under a summary section or in a column on the side of the document. In most situations, you should include no more than 10 skills to avoid creating clutter on your resume. Use the job description to determine which skills are most essential to the job. Remember to incorporate keywords from the description, which will help you pass applicant tracking systems and make it easier for hiring managers to understand your qualifications.

5. Education

Your education section should generally sit at the bottom of your resume. However, recent college graduates can place this section above their professional experience. This section should provide the hiring manager insights into your relevant educational background and qualifications. Some employers may ask for candidates with a specific degree or training, so be sure to highlight those details. List the following information in your education section:

- Names of schools attended
- Locations of schools attended
- Degrees received (starting with the most advanced)
- Relevant courses (optional)
- Relevant certificates

Your education section will likely depend on your career experience. A recent college graduate (within the last five years) may include their graduation year or GPA, as long as it is above a 3.5. Once you graduate from college, you also do not need to mention anything about your high school education.

6. Organized presentation

An effective resume will provide an easy reading experience for the hiring manager. Each section should have a distinct heading, and there should be enough white space between them to ensure your document does not look cluttered. You can also get creative with your formatting by incorporating some colors in your headings or other design features, but you must maintain professionalism and make choices in line with your potential employer's style. Most applicants use a reverse-chronological format, where you list your professional experience from most recent to least. However, some career situations may require you to think about using a functional or

combination format. For example, you may switch your resume type if you are making a significant career change or have employment gaps.

7. Proofreading

A good resume will not have any typos, misspellings or other grammatical errors. Always perform multiple reviews of your document and have someone else read it so they can catch anything you might not have seen. An error-free resume will prove that you can produce quality work, along with showing that you have an attention to detail. If you include links in your resume, click on them to ensure they go to the proper location—this will avoid causing any frustration to the reader.

Additional components to include

The following elements are optional but can be incorporated on the side or bottom of a resume to display your unique qualifications as a candidate:

- **Awards and honors:** You can list these achievements under your experience section or highlight them separately. They should be related to the position to showcase your professional abilities. It is especially effective to include any industry-wide recognition you have received.
- **Languages:** If you are proficient in more than one language and believe they might be an asset for the position, include them and your level of fluency.
- **Testimonials:** You may want to showcase an impressive client or manager testimonial as demonstrable proof of the value you offer. Make sure that it is brief and does not take up too much space in your document.
- **Publications:** If you have written for or appeared in well-known publications, include a link if possible or the title of your piece. You can also mention any significant speaking appearances you have made. These details can demonstrate that you have expert knowledge in your industry.
- **Activities and hobbies:** Only mention your interests outside of work if they seem to align with the position. They can help prove your interest in the role or provide additional relevant experience not covered in your other sections. For example, if you were applying to a company that sells fitness equipment, you might mention that you are an avid weightlifter.

Common Resume Mistakes and How To fix Them

1. Including a resume objective

A resume objective is a brief statement about what you're hoping to achieve in your career. Instead of including a resume objective, write a professional summary at the top of your resume. A professional summary describes your unique qualifications to show employers how you can benefit their organization as a new employee. If you have limited work experience, you can include your career objectives in your professional summary, but explain how those goals relate to the new job and the company to which you're applying.

2. Describing unrelated work experience

When writing your resume, list work experience that relates to the new position. Providing information about your relevant experience shows employers you have the qualifications to perform relevant tasks well. If you're transitioning to a new industry or position, focus on listing skills or accomplishments that highlight your transferrable skills, rather than the job responsibilities you've had in other roles. For instance, if you're applying to a customer service role but you have experience as a cashier, use your resume to explain how you interacted with customers in that position.

3. Providing few details

For each job on your resume, include enough details to explain how you were successful in the role. Aim to provide five bullet points about your responsibilities and achievements in your current or most recent position. For all other jobs on your resume, write three bullet points. This level of detail demonstrates your competency and professionalism. When writing about your work experience, use action verbs to start each bullet point, followed by the impact or result of each action. You can also use quantitative data, such as percentages and dollar amounts, to provide greater detail in your experience section.

4. Adding references

Though many employers ask for references to evaluate job candidates, it's usually unnecessary to include this information on your resume. Typically, employers request references later in the hiring process, after they've reviewed candidates' resumes. Only add references when a potential employer specifically asks you to include this information on your resume. Otherwise, you can

create a separate document for your references. In this document, use the same header, font and style as your resume to maintain cohesiveness among your application materials.

5. Listing irrelevant skills

While you likely have a diverse skill set, use your resume to target skills related to the new job. Many employers provide a list of skills in the job description, so read postings carefully to ensure you're including relevant skills on your resume. For example, if a job posting asks for candidates who have experience using specific software, you can list the application as a skill on your resume. Listing relevant skills shows employers you have the technical abilities and character traits to excel in the new position.

6. Using the same resume for all applications

When submitting multiple job applications, customize your resume for each job to show employers why you're the best candidate for that specific role. It's helpful to create a master resume template that you can copy and save as a new document for each job to which you apply. In a customized resume, you can include specific keywords and phrases from the job description, which can help your resume pass an applicant tracking system (ATS). You can also highlight the skills and experience you have that are directly related to the new role.

7. Having outdated contact information

It's important to ensure the contact information on your resume is up-to-date so employers can contact you. Make sure you provide your current phone number and an email you check often. If you've recently moved, list your new location, including the city and state. Providing the correct information on your resume ensures a potential employer can contact you to schedule an interview or ask questions about your application.

8. Describing job duties only

In your work experience section, provide information about both your job duties and accomplishments you've had in each role. Your accomplishments are unique endeavors that can help employers understand your value as an employee. Including accomplishments on your resume can help you distinguish yourself from other candidates, who may have performed similar duties in their past positions. Aim to connect each job duty or task to an achievement that shows hiring managers how your work performance benefited your past employers.

9. Creating a short or lengthy resume

Employers often evaluate candidates quickly, and a lengthy resume may deter them from reviewing your application. Keep your resume to one page in length to highlight the most important details about your experience and skills. If you have over 10 years of relevant work experience, you may add a second page to your resume to describe your extensive qualifications. Similarly, employers may consider candidates with resumes of less than one page to have insufficient experience for the position. If you've recently graduated or you have limited professional experience, consider adding details about your education, internships, volunteer work or extracurricular activities. Describe how those experiences have prepared you for the new position.

10. Making grammatical or formatting errors

Before submitting your resume to employers, review it carefully for errors in spelling, grammar or punctuation. Sending a clean, well-written resume to employers conveys professionalism and creates a positive impression. You can use word-processing software or online applications to help you proofread your resume. It's also helpful to ask a friend or family member to read your resume because they might notice errors you may have missed. Similarly, make sure you've formatted your resume in a logical style with readable fonts and white space. Some common resume fonts include Times New Roman, Arial or Georgia. Avoid using bright colors or graphics to ensure your resume focuses on your skills and qualifications.

11. Using an unprofessional email address

In your resume header, provide a professional email address, such as one with your first and last name or a variation of it. It may be helpful to create a new email you can use solely for correspondence about your job applications. When you use a professional email address, it helps your resume appear polished and formal.

12. Including salary requirements

While you may have specific salary requirements for a new position, refrain from including this information on your resume. Typically, you can discuss your salary requirements with employers later in the hiring process, such as during an interview or after receiving an employment offer. When establishing your salary requirements, make sure you research average salary information for your field, experience level and location. Use this information to choose an appropriate salary range for the new position.

13.Using jargon or cliches

Using industry terminology, cliches or other repetitive vocabulary may detract from the relevant information you're providing on your resume. Instead, use specific, actionable language to describe your experience and qualifications. Explain your job duties and career achievements using simple language that's easy for hiring managers to understand. Providing information in a clear, concise manner can demonstrate effective communication, which is a valuable skill for many employers.

14. Listing hobbies

You have limited space on your resume to describe your qualifications and attract employers' attention. For this reason, avoid listing hobbies that are unrelated to the new position. If you have hobbies that apply to the role, include them in the appropriate section of your resume. For example, if you're applying for a teaching position and you enjoy tutoring young children on the weekends, include this information in a section about your volunteer work.

15.Mislabeling the file

It's common to upload a resume on a website or email the document to potential employers. When submitting your application electronically, choose an appropriate resume_file_name. You can save the file by using your name followed by the word "resume." This file name ensures employers can easily locate your application when they're ready to review it.